INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 005 · HOT

Quantinuum

Quantum Computing · Broomfield, CO / Cambridge, UK · IPO pending (~$12.7B target valuation)

Honeywell spin-off Quantinuum is heading for a ~$12.7B IPO with a freshly expanded C-suite - a textbook overnight unicorn with a brand-elevation budget, an Anglo-American footprint, and no motorsport history at all.

76 OPPORTUNITY / 100	TIMING WINDOW **WARM**	SERIES **F1**	RECOMMENDED TEAM **Aston Martin**	ACTION HORIZON **6-8 WKS**

THE CASE

Quantinuum is the highest-priority class in our entire mandate: a born-big spin-off (out of Honeywell) heading into a ~$12.7B IPO, up 27% on its $10B September 2025 valuation, that has never entered motorsport. Two structural facts make it compelling. First, an IPO is a one-time brand-elevation moment, and an F1 association is among the fastest ways for a deep-tech company to acquire global enterprise visibility and the kind of mainstream credibility a quantum business cannot buy through technical channels alone. Second, the company has just expanded its leadership - a new CEO in Rajeeb (Raj) Hazra and a new CMO in Lawrence Schwartz - which is exactly the configuration that approves first-mover brand investments to establish a public-market identity. Because no quantum brand exists anywhere on the grid, Quantinuum would define the category rather than contest it.

WHY NOW

The IPO roadshow is the window. Leadership is actively investing in public-market visibility, enterprise credibility and a differentiated narrative, and a new CEO-plus-CMO pairing typically sets the brand agenda in its first two quarters. A multi-year F1 innovation-partner deal signed around the listing compounds the story - turning a finance event into a global brand moment - and there is no competitor clock forcing a rushed, defensive posture, so the deal can be shaped on Quantinuum's terms if it is opened now rather than after the listing settles.

SPINOFF UNICORN · NEVER ENTERED · FUNDING EVENT · DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY ASTON MARTIN

Aston Martin is the fit. Its premium engineering gravitas and British identity align with Quantinuum's Cambridge-and-Colorado footprint, and its hospitality audience is exactly the C-suite and government-adjacent enterprise buyer a quantum business courts. The association positions Quantinuum as 'the quantum edge in performance R&D' - a precision-and-compute halo on the grid's most boardroom-credible team - rather than as a mass-market consumer sponsor, which is the wrong register for this category.

VALUE TO ASTON MARTIN — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A (developing). Quantum and advanced classical optimisation increasingly touch the problems an F1 team actually faces - aerodynamic and strategy simulation, logistics and scheduling across a global calendar, and materials R&D. Positioned as an innovation and R&D partner, Quantinuum offers Aston Martin a credible compute-frontier collaboration and a powerful talent-attraction halo, with a genuine roadmap toward simulation use cases rather than an empty logo. The honest framing is a forward-looking technical partnership: real engagement on hard optimisation problems, growing into deeper integration over the multi-year term.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Innovation / Quantum Partner tier on Aston Martin, minimum three years, estimated $3-6M/yr, structured as an R&D-and-brand halo timed around the listing, with category exclusivity for quantum computing and a defined joint R&D workstream so the partnership has technical substance from day one.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Lawrence Schwartz

CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, QUANTINUUM - VERIFIED

Brings 20+ years of global B2B marketing leadership with a track record of scaling high-margin businesses from $100M to over $1B; most recently led major repositioning at Aspen Technology that lifted brand preference and market share - precisely the IPO-grade brand mandate an F1 partnership would anchor. Co-decision-makers: CEO Rajeeb (Raj) Hazra and the CFO/IR function during the listing window.

OPENING ANGLE

> *"Lawrence, you repositioned AspenTech into a billion-dollar brand - you know an IPO is a credibility event. Quantum is the one category no rival on the F1 grid can claim, and Aston Martin is the boardroom audience. 25 minutes before the roadshow?"*

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING	CAPACITY	BRAND FIT	URGENCY	OPS FIT
16 / 20	**20** / 20	**15** / 20	**12** / 20	**13** / 20
The IPO roadshow is a once-only brand-elevation moment, and a recently expanded C-suite (new CEO and CMO) signals a deliberate scale-up posture.	Honeywell spin-off targeting a ~$12.7B IPO, a 27% premium over its $10B September 2025 round - capacity is a non-issue.	Quantum computing is the ultimate precision-and-compute narrative, and the Anglo-American footprint suits a British team, though the category is more halo than literal in-car today.	No direct quantum rival exists on the grid, so the forcing function is the IPO window itself rather than a competitor.	MODE A (developing): compute and optimisation R&D around simulation, strategy and logistics is a credible roadmap, even if not yet a literal in-car system.

RISKS & COUNTERS

IPO QUIET PERIOD Securities rules may restrict spend and announcements around the listing. **Counter:** Sign quietly and activate post-listing; use the roadshow period to build internal consensus rather than to publicise.

DEEP-TECH BRAND CAUTION A quantum firm may view F1 as off-strategy or too consumer-facing. **Counter:** Position strictly as enterprise credibility, government/partner visibility and talent attraction, with a real joint R&D workstream - not consumer marketing.

SOURCES

- http://www.techtimes.com/articles/317216/20260526/quantinuum-ipo-targets-127b-valuation-honeywell-spinoff-reports-31m-2025-revenue.htm
- https://www.quantinuum.com/press-releases/quantinuum-names-rajeeb-raj-hazra-chief-executive-officer